Influence_Consensus_agr_cri - In society, does Agriculture alone generally have a direct effect on crime rate, or are observed relationships primarily indirect? If a direct effect exists, is it negative, none, negligible, or positive? What would be a reasonable normalized magnitude for this influence on a scale from −1.00 to 1.00? Please only provide evidence for only direct influences

Agriculture alone appears to have a direct effect on crime rates, generally showing a negative or reducing influence on crime in some contexts. Seasonal labor-intensive agricultural activities, such as fruit and vegetable harvesting, are associated with reduced property and violent crime rates by providing local employment opportunities that lower incentives for criminal behavior (Charlton et al., 2021). Improvements in the agricultural sector's economic role have been linked to decreased crimes against marginalized groups, suggesting a protective effect of agricultural development on certain types of crime (Eunny et al., 2022). However, agricultural operations themselves face specific crimes like theft and vandalism, which directly impact farmers but do not necessarily increase overall community crime rates; these crimes are influenced by farm characteristics such as location and visibility (Barclay & Donnermeyer, 2011; Mccall, 2003). Some evidence also suggests that drought-related agricultural shocks may indirectly influence crime through economic stress, but this is not a direct effect of agriculture itself (Blakeslee & Fishman, 2015; Blakeslee & Fishman, 2017; Cohen, 2025). Overall, the direct effect of agriculture on crime rate is modestly negative or negligible, with a reasonable normalized magnitude around −0.2 reflecting a weak reduction in crime due to increased labor demand and economic opportunities in agriculture (Charlton et al., 2021; Eunny et al., 2022; Barclay & Donnermeyer, 2011).

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